The Rite of Empowerment

Toh 1269 · Derge Tengyur

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The Rite of Empowerment, in Tibetan Wang Kurwé Choga, whose Sanskrit title is not given in the opening lines but corresponds to a rite of abhiṣeka, is a ritual manual for conferring empowerment in the maṇḍala of glorious Hevajra. Opening with homage to Hevajra, it sets out the whole sequence of the rite: the preliminary approach recitations, the preparation of the site, the laying out of lines and colored powders of the painted maṇḍala, the generation and worship of the deities with offerings, feast and fire offering, and then the disciples' entry into the maṇḍala and the outer and inner empowerments, from the water and crown empowerments through the secret, wisdom-gnosis and fourth empowerments, ending with the dismissal of the deities and the dissolving of the maṇḍala. Its colophon attributes it to the great master Prajñāśrī. It is Toh 1269 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the section of tantra commentaries, among the ritual works of the Hevajra cycle.

The Rite of Empowerment.

Homage to glorious Hevajra.

Now I shall explain the sequence of activities for the painted maṇḍala.

First one should perform the approach. One recites a vast number of recitations of one's own chosen deity, a hundred thousand recitations of the principal deity of the maṇḍala, and ten thousand recitations for each of the other gods and goddesses. And if one asks how the recitation is to be done: at the place where the maṇḍala is to be made, make a square maṇḍala one cubit in size, and anoint it with the five products of the cow and with sweet fragrances such as sandalwood. Sprinkle it also with the five nectars. Then make nine dots of scent and place clean flowers upon them, imagining these to be the deities of the maṇḍala. Then invite the deities into them and dissolve them into them. Then perform the outer, inner and secret offerings, the praises, and everything up to the tasting of the nectar.

Then, assuming the pride of the chosen deity, recite the recitation of the chosen deity. Assuming the pride of the principal, recite the mantra of the principal. Assuming the pride of each of the eight goddesses in turn, recite: oṃ āḥ gaurī hūṃ betālī caurī pramohā pukkasī sabarī caṇḍalī oṃ āḥ ḍombinī hūṃ.

If, in a dream, the chosen deity or the principal of the maṇḍala says, "The recitation is not needed," then break it off even though the recitation is not complete. After that, make offerings and praises, and with the hundred-syllable mantra request the deities to depart. Then the activities of the maṇḍala should be performed. That is the first, the approach.

Next, the ground should be taken possession of. This too has eight parts: searching for and examining the ground; requesting the ground; securing the ground firmly; purifying the ground; blessing the ground; expelling the obstructors; planting the stakes; and the master, endowed with the three samādhis, seated in the center, being worshipped and petitioned from the four directions by the four goddesses, Gaurī and the others.

Of these, searching for and examining the ground is as follows. The ground should be good, free of thorns and debris, free of faults, sloping toward the east and the north, and furnished with flowers, trees and water. Or else it should be pleasing to the mind. That is searching for and examining the ground.

Requesting the ground is as follows. The master, abiding in the samādhi of Hevajra, makes a maṇḍala one cubit in size with cow dung that has not fallen onto the ground. On it he visualizes the maṇḍala of Hevajra, performs the outer and inner offerings, and gives torma to the world protectors. Then, setting his right kneecap on the ground and joining his palms, he should request the ground, saying: "I make this request of the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, piśācas and the rest who dwell on this ground. Here, in this place on the ground, I wish to make the maṇḍala of Hevajra for the sake of the patron so-and-so. I shall do it here without harming you and with your forbearance. As I sleep in this place, show me signs in a dream!" Having said this, he should abide in the samādhi of the principal, do the recitation, and sleep in the lion's posture. If in the dream they say, "Do it without harming us," then he should do it right there.

Securing the ground firmly is as follows. Once the ground has been obtained, on the first morning of the following day, wipe clean the earlier maṇḍala, visualize the maṇḍala of Hevajra on it, and perform the outer and inner offerings. Give torma to the direction protectors and say this: "Having obtained this much ground, I shall make the maṇḍala of Hevajra and the others. You must not waver in mind; be without obstruction and give your help!" Thus one should command them.

After that, one should make the petition, reciting three times:

From all the directions,
however many perfect buddhas dwell,
bodhisattvas and arhats,
for the sake of me and of so-and-so,
remain steadfast, and then,
you who possess the higher knowledges, accept this offering water.

Then say: "O Blessed One, having accepted my offering water, please bestow your blessing and remain steadfast."

If in the dream the ground is not obtained as a pleasing one, assume the pride of the wrathful one, perform a fire offering of the fierce rites, expel the obstructors, and then proceed as before. That is securing the ground firmly.

Purifying the ground is as follows. Perform the pacifying fire offering in the proper way, visualize the earth goddess in the heart of the fire god, and make offerings and the fire offering to her. Then, by saying oṃ āḥ hūṃ muḥ, request her to depart into the sky. After that, visualize the site, of whatever size is desired, as a square, bring to mind the lord of the nāgas, and dig.

The lord of the nāgas, during the three months of autumn, lies with his left flank lowered to the ground, his head pointing east and his face looking south. During the three months of winter he lies with his head pointing south and his face looking west. During the three months of spring he lies with his head pointing west and his face looking north. During the three months of summer he lies with his head pointing north and his face looking east.

The method of digging the ground is this: one should dig from the nāga's head, back and lap. For the sake of delightful accomplishments, on the side of his chest, at the throat, the navel and the knee, according to whether one wants the superior, middling or lesser accomplishment, one should dig while imagining him lying to the right or the left.

Remove the earth, and when it has been cleared of stones, gravel, charred wood, charcoal, bones, potsherds, clods and the like, mix other good, moist earth with sweet fragrances and pour it in. Then fill the pit with water mixed with sweet fragrances while reciting the syllable hūṃ, and pound it firm. Upon that surface, level as the palm of the hand, imagine a celestial palace with four doors, endowed with ornaments and so forth. Then recite the mantra of all activities over incense and the water of the five nectars, and sprinkle it. Recite

the mantra of all activities over medicines, grains and jewels, and insert them.

Blessing the ground is as follows. Sitting in the center of the maṇḍala, one should practice the yoga of Hevajra. From khaṃ meditate on the ground as space. From suṃ meditate on Mount Meru, yellow and square, equal to space. From laṃ meditate on the square maṇḍala of Mahendra, yellow, its four corners marked by four three-pronged vajras. From hūṃ meditate on the ground as vajra. Then, by saying me dinī bajrī bha ba bajra bandha hūṃ, bless the ground as luminous. That is blessing the ground.

Expelling the obstructors is as follows. Saying hrīḥ three times, the master comes outside and sits at the boundary of Īśāna, the northeast. He imagines that emanations come forth from the wheel of the maṇḍala that has arisen in the place of his own heart and fill the sky, and he says: "Victors of the ten directions, together with your heirs, I pray you to remain, in order to bless and protect me together with my disciples." Saying this, he draws them into the center of the vajra on the moon maṇḍala in his heart and imagines that they have become one with himself.

He assumes the pride of Hevajra in his own body. Saying hūṃ and holding the half posture of the sattva, he imagines a moon maṇḍala arising from ṭa in his left eye and a sun maṇḍala arising from ma in his right. From the two eyeballs comes hūṃ, darting wildly and blazing like the fire at the end of the eon, and with it he casts the vajra gaze. Then, twirling the vajra in his right hand and ringing the bell in his left, which he holds at his hip, he bends his head and eyes slightly to the left. He imagines crossed vajras arising from hūṃ on the soles of both feet, stands in the northeast, and says this:

Listen, all you hosts of obstructors,
you who dwell in body, speech and mind!
The glorious Hevajra and the others
make the wheel of protection.
Through this blazing vajra form,
if anyone transgresses the commitment,
the three desires are to be roused and he is to be slain;
without doubt he will be shattered into pieces.

Having said this, with stances such as the right-extended and the left-extended, he circles the maṇḍala three times, saying hūṃ. That is the stage of expelling the obstructors.

Planting the stakes is as follows. Sprinkle iron stakes eight finger-widths long with scent and nectar water, set them in front of you, and meditate on them as empty. From within emptiness, imagine that they become a single dark green hūṃ. From that, meditate on Amṛtakuṇḍalin, three-faced and six-armed, from the navel upward; imagine the lower part as a three-sided stake blazing with light. Then, beginning from Īśāna and proceeding clockwise, recite over the stakes the mantra oṃ he bajra bighnān ucchaṭaya hūṃ phaṭ and plant them in the ten directions, imagining that they are driven down until they reach the golden ground below. That is planting the stakes.

The vajra master endowed with the three samādhis being worshipped and petitioned from the four directions by the four goddesses possessed of samādhi, Gaurī and the others, is as follows. So that the maṇḍala may be drawn, the yogin of Gaurī, from the east, offers the five kinds of offerings to the principal in the center and says this:

Peace of all the tathāgatas,
abode of all the tathāgatas,
supreme selflessness of all phenomena,
please explain the sublime maṇḍala!

Thus he exhorts. From the south, the yogin of Caurī offers the five kinds of offerings to the principal in the center and says this:

Perfectly complete in every characteristic,
perfectly free of all that is not a characteristic,
Samantabhadra, supreme in body,
please explain the sublime maṇḍala!

Thus he exhorts. From the west, the yogin of Pramohā offers the five kinds of offerings to the principal in the center and says this:

Supreme peace, arisen from the supreme,
purifier of the conduct of wisdom,
Samantabhadra, supreme in speech,
please explain the sublime maṇḍala!

Thus he exhorts. From the north, the yogin of Betālī offers the five kinds of offerings to the principal in the center and says this:

Great mind of all sentient beings,
pure by nature and without stain,
Samantabhadra, supreme in mind,

please explain the sublime maṇḍala!

Thus he exhorts. Then he rises from the center of the maṇḍala, visualizes all the tathāgatas filling the sky, and should say this: oṃ sarba tathāgata pāda bandhanaṃ karomi. With this he bows at the feet of all the tathāgatas. Then, rising, he generates the pride of Hevajra and says this:

I myself am the vajra-holder;
Vajrasattva is I myself.
I am the Buddha, the great king;
I am the vajra-holder of great power.
I am the king, lord of yogins;
I am steadfast Vajrapāṇi,
the lord, the very self of the great vajra.
Please bestow your blessing and remain!

Thus he exhorts. That is taking possession of the ground.

Now the preparation is taught. It has four parts: preparing the earth goddess, preparing the deities, preparing the vase, and preparing the disciples.

Of these, preparing the earth goddess is as follows. In the center of the maṇḍala make a dot of scent, and on the dot imagine a yellow syllable laṃ. It melts into light and becomes the earth goddess, yellow in color, adorned with various jewel ornaments, with one face and two arms, her right hand holding a rosary and her left holding a golden vase. Then, with the four syllables jaḥ hūṃ baṃ hoḥ, the earth goddess who has come into the sky in front is summoned, made to enter, bound and delighted. Offering the five kinds of offerings and joining the palms, one says:

In the ways of conduct of all the buddhas, the protectors,
and in the special
grounds and perfections,
you, goddess, have been the witness.
Just as the protector Śākyasiṃha
vanquished the armies of Māra,
so I, having vanquished the hosts of māras,
shall draw the maṇḍala.

When this is said three times, the earth goddess is pleased, and with a radiance of joy she says, "Make the maṇḍala of Hevajra!" and dissolves into

the ground. That is preparing the earth goddess.

Preparing the deities is as follows. At the seat of each of the nine deities make a dot of scent and nectar, and imagine these as nine seats. Upon them, reciting the heart mantra of each deity and placing one flower on each, imagine the nine samaya beings. Then, with the four mudrās of jaḥ hūṃ baṃ hoḥ and so forth, the wisdom deities are summoned, made to enter, bound and brought under control, and one imagines them as nondual. Then, offering the five kinds of offerings, one performs the twentyfold praise, as follows:

Supreme nature of all things,
abiding from the beginning as the self of all,
pure as the two, method and wisdom:
Hevajra, I bow to you.

Then one says this:

To the Blessed One, Hevajra,
king of knowledge, I bow and offer praise.
Here in this vajra maṇḍala
I wish to draw you, O Protector,
in order to benefit the disciples
and also for the sake of worshipping you.
Therefore, Blessed One, it is fitting
that you grant your blessing to me, your devotee.
Consider me, O buddhas,
you who work for the welfare of the wheel of beings,
bodhisattvas who abide in the fruit,
and whatever other mantra deities there are,
gods and world protectors,
bhūtas and bodhisattvas
who delight in the teaching for sentient beings.
I, so-and-so, a vajra-holder
possessed of the vajra eye,
shall draw the Hevajra maṇḍala as it truly is,
as far as I am able with the offerings,
for the sake of beings and of myself.
To me, together with my disciples,
it is fitting that you grant your blessing.

This is said three times while holding incense. That is preparing the deities.

Preparing the vase is as follows. The shape of the vase is round like the water maṇḍala, with a slender foot, a drooping lip and a large belly. Make nine of these and wash them clean with scented water. On a maṇḍala spread cotton cloth or white silk, scatter flowers loosely upon it, and set down the vases described above. Then anoint them with sweet fragrances such as white sandalwood, mixed with white pigment. Then draw eight lotus petals on each, and at the center of each draw its own hand emblem.

Then imagine the victorious vase as devoid of substance. From that it becomes a single white syllable khaṃ. This melts into light, and from it a vase like the one above arises. Inside it imagine an eight-petalled lotus arising from the syllable hrīḥ. Upon that imagine a moon maṇḍala from a. Upon that imagine a sun maṇḍala from aṃ. Upon that imagine a single dark blue syllable hūṃ. This melts into light, and from it imagine a dark blue vajra marked with hūṃ. This melts into light, and from it imagine Hevajra with eight faces, four legs, sixteen arms and twenty-four eyes, wearing the six mudrās. In his eight right hands he holds skull cups containing an elephant, a horse, a donkey and the rest; in his eight left hands he holds skull cups containing the earth goddess and the rest. His yellow hair stands upright, and he is adorned with various ornaments. Or else imagine the complete maṇḍala.

Then place the vase in the center of the maṇḍala of the six families. Then with the four, jaḥ hūṃ baṃ hoḥ and so on, the wisdom deities are summoned, made to enter, bound, brought under control and so forth. Then with the six goddesses, Mohavajrā and the others, bless the six sense bases, and with the three, Khecarī and the others, bless the three places. Imagine the lord of the family, the causal Hevajra, as the crown ornament.

Then purify and sprinkle the offering water and the rest. The mantras for purifying, sprinkling and the rest are these. oṃ sarba saṃśodhani hūṃ phaṭ is the mantra for the flowers and the rest. oṃ āḥ svāhā is the mantra for purifying the five nectars placed in the skull cup. oṃ āḥ hūṃ svāhā is the mantra for purifying the samaya water. oṃ śrī hūṃ ghaṃ jaṃ svāhā is the mantra for preparing the five meats.

Then imagine those five kinds of offerings as five hūṃ. The hūṃ melt into light, and imagine that the flowers and the rest become excellent and endowed with light: oṃ āḥ hūṃ svāhā.

Then, to the victorious vase, say oṃ bajra sva bhā ba svāhā and offer cloth. Say jaḥ hūṃ baṃ hoḥ khaṃ raṃ and offer the offering water. Say oṃ ni ri ti

hūṃ khaṃ and offer water to refresh the face.

These supreme and excellent flowers,
from a stainless and pure place of growth,
I offer with faith:
accept them and protect me with your kindness.
oṃ bajra puṣpe āḥ hūṃ svāhā

Supreme of scents, sprung from the forest,
a host of fragrances, unsurpassed incense,
I offer with faith:
accept it and protect me with your kindness.
oṃ bajra dhūpe āḥ hūṃ svāhā

Auspicious, vanquishing the grahas,
virtuous, and dispelling the darkness,
I offer with faith:
accept it and protect me with your kindness.
oṃ bajra dīpa āḥ hūṃ svāhā

This pure scent, compounded from the co-emergent,
which delights the nose,
I offer with faith:
accept it and protect me with your kindness.
oṃ bajra gandhe āḥ hūṃ svāhā

All pure food offerings, complete in every part,
with things to eat and things to chew,
possessed of color, scent and taste,
I offer: please accept each one.
oṃ bajra nai bi dye āḥ hūṃ svāhā

Then pour good scented water into a conch bowl and set it at the mouth of the vase. Tie to the victorious vase a white thread over which hūṃ has been recited seven times. Soak a garland of flowers in water scented with white sandalwood, bind it around the middle of a vajra, and set it at the mouth of the conch bowl. Then recite the mantra of the principal one hundred and eight times and pour it into the vase; by its power Hevajra, father and mother, melts into light. Then fill the vase with good scented water. Then, reciting oṃ hūṃ svāhā, one should tie on and put in place the mouth ornament and the neck band. Bless the five grains, the five medicines, the five nectars and the five jewels with the mantra of the principal one hundred and eight times, wrap

them in cloth, tie them to the mouth ornament and put them into the vase water, then fumigate with incense and set the vase down.

Then, for the other eight vases, generate each one's own heart syllable, gaṃ, caṃ and the rest, invite the deity that is each one's wisdom being, and perform the summoning and the rest as before. Then place them in the maṇḍala of the six families as before.

Then, inside the vase of all activities, generate Amṛtakuṇḍalin from the syllable hūṃ through the sequence of the three rites, and perform the invitation and the rest as above. Place it at the northeast corner of the maṇḍala of the six families, and petition with these words: "Until this maṇḍala of yours is completed, please guard against the malicious obstructors." That is preparing the vase.

Then, preparing the disciples is as follows. Going outside, the master abides in the samādhi of Hevajra. Then the disciples, their bodies protected, bathed clean and dressed in clean clothes, scatter garlands of flowers to the vajra master, bow to the master, and should petition him:

Great joy, you who are my teacher,
master, please consider me.
I seek the great protector
who teaches the way of great awakening.

Grant me also the awakening mind.
The Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha:
grant me these three refuges.
Into the supreme city of great liberation,
O Protector, I wish to enter.

This is said three times. Then the master calls the disciple who has the proper characteristics and should say this:

Since you are a vessel of the great way,
come here, my son. The rite
of the conduct of the Great Vehicle's secret mantra
I shall teach you well.
The perfect buddhas who have passed,
likewise those who have not yet come,
and the protectors who have arisen now
and remain for the benefit of beings:

all of them knew
this supreme and excellent rite of secret mantra,
and so, heroes at the foot of the tree of awakening,
they attained signless omniscience.
The practice of secret mantra is without fault:
through it the protector Śākyasiṃha
vanquished the utterly fearsome armies of Māra,
great hosts though they were.
Therefore, to attain omniscience,
my son, form this resolve!

This is what he says. Then he has them perform the confession of wrongdoing and the rest:

Whatever wrongdoing I have done,
caused to be done, or rejoiced in,
having come into the presence of the buddhas,
all of it I confess.
In the accumulation of merit
from meditation and recitation
of the buddhas, the bodhisattvas,
the pratyekabuddhas, the arhats and all beings,
in that I rejoice.
The generation of the mind, the full awakening,
the turning of the wheel of Dharma,
and the conduct of the hosts of bodhisattvas:
from this day on I go to these for refuge.
Just as the buddhas came to be,
and just as the fortunate bodhisattvas
generated the awakening mind,
in that very way I generate the mind.
O Protector, please consider me.
All you buddhas who remain, without exception,
from this very time until I become a buddha,
please look upon me, unsurpassed ones.
The Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha,
the unsurpassed Three Jewels,
and the vow of the buddha yoga,

I shall take up in perfect truth.
For the great and supreme vajra family,
the vajra, the bell and the mudrā too
I shall take up in perfect truth,
and the masters too I shall take up.
For the pleasing commitment
of the great and supreme jewel family,
six times each and every day
I shall always give the four kinds of giving.
For the sublime and supreme lotus family,
which arises from great awakening,
the three vehicles, outer, inner and secret,
the sublime Dharma, I shall also take up.
For the great and supreme action family,
I shall take up in perfect truth
the possession of all the vows,
and perform acts of worship as far as I can.
The discipline of moral restraint,
the gathering of virtuous qualities,
and working for the benefit of beings, the three kinds of moral discipline,
I shall likewise take up firmly.
Through these virtuous actions of mine,
swiftly attaining buddhahood before long in the world,
the sentient beings sunk in the ocean of saṃsāra
I shall deliver into unsurpassed awakening itself.

When they have made this request, the master should perform the protection of the disciples, reciting the mantra of the wrathful one over the tooth sticks.

The rite of the tooth stick is as follows. From the tip of a branch of an udumbara or aśvattha tree, cut a stick twelve finger-widths in length. To the tip of a tooth stick that is straight, not split and not eaten by worms, tie a garland of flowers, anoint it with sweet fragrance, and meditate on the tooth stick as empty. From that it becomes a single dark blue hūṃ blazing with light, and from that imagine that a luminous tooth stick arises. Then, counting on the tooth stick's garland of flowers, recite the mantra and bless it.

Then, with cow dung that has not fallen onto the ground, sweet fragrance and the five nectars, make a square maṇḍala one cubit in size in the west, and set

the disciple upon it. Having blessed the disciple as Vairocana, take up urine with the vajra fist. Saying oṃ, make a dot on the crown of the head; saying āḥ, make a dot at the throat; saying hūṃ, make a dot at the heart. Imagine the dots as seats, and imagine the three, oṃ āḥ hūṃ, as Khecarī and the others. Then perform the offerings of flowers and the rest: offer flowers at the crown of the head, offer incense in front, offer lamps and scent at the heart, and offer the food offering in the hands.

Then, facing east and keeping silent, the disciple chews the tooth stick. When he has finished chewing, he scrubs his teeth, and, without breaking the stick and without tossing it this way or that, he throws it straight ahead into the root maṇḍala. Or else he throws it into a square one cubit in size. Then:

If it points toward oneself
and its tip stands upright,
that is called the supreme accomplishment.
Likewise, if it points elsewhere,
that is said to be the middling accomplishment.
If it points to an intermediate direction or to the north,
one obtains worldly accomplishments.
If, of a hundred tooth sticks thrown,
one should point downward,
that is certainly the accomplishment
of the underworld; of that there is no doubt.

Then he washes his hands with scented water, rinses his mouth by taking water in and spitting it out. Then he is made to drink three palmfuls of water over which this mantra has been recited: oṃ hri bi śuddha dharmā pā paṃ ni śca a se śo dha sarba bi kalpan a pa na ya hūṃ.

After that, the Dharma should be taught in order to gladden the minds of the disciples. Its purpose is to purify the faults of speech and to observe the omens of the superior and middling accomplishments.

Then recite the root mantra over kuśa grass and meditate on the kuśa as empty. Then it becomes hūṃ, and from hūṃ imagine that the kuśa arises. Instruct the disciples, "Place it at the side where your head will lie." Again, generate kuśa from hūṃ, recite the mantra of Amṛtakuṇḍalin over it, and spread it out as a mat as well. Its purpose is to purify the faults of mind and to make the dreams sharp.

Then sprinkle a thread of five colors with scent and with the water of the five nectars, and meditate on it as empty. From emptiness it becomes hūṃ, and from hūṃ imagine it as a vajra thread. Recite the mantra of Amṛtakuṇḍalin six times, tying six knots, and tie the thread on the disciple's left upper arm. Make it firm also with the hundred-syllable mantra. Then say:

Fair-faced ones, take this!
Tomorrow, in the daytime,
you will behold the cities
whose nature is great liberation.

Then, as before, make the five kinds of offerings to the disciples, cast the torma for the direction protectors outside, and, sitting inside, worship the maṇḍala of the deities in preparation. In that very place, the excellent disciples lie on kuśa mats beside the maṇḍala in the lion's posture in order to observe the signs of their dreams. Without speaking, meditating on the chosen deity and reciting the mantra, they go to sleep.

Then in the morning, at the end of the night, one should ask what dreams each of them saw. Having heard the answers, one should recite the mantra without anxiety over whether the dreams are good or bad. If they have seen good dreams, one should rejoice with the disciple and point out the three accomplishments, superior, middling and lesser. If they have seen bad ones, recite the mantra of Amṛtakuṇḍalin over the five products of the cow or the five nectars and have them drink it, and also perform the protection. If one is able, one should perform the fierce fire offering and clear away the misgivings. That is the stage of preparing the disciples.

Entering into the activity also has two parts: the rite of the maṇḍala and the rite of empowerment. The rite of the maṇḍala in turn has thirteen parts: laying out the lines; applying the colors; arranging the symbols; generating the samaya maṇḍala; inviting the wisdom maṇḍala and making the two nondual; making the outer, inner and secret offerings to it; praise; the nectar; the gathering; making the offering of torma; the offering of the fire ritual; worshipping the wisdom deities and requesting them to depart; and dismantling the maṇḍala.

Of these, the stage of laying out the lines is as follows. Perform the offering, the praise and the rite of the nectar for the deities of the preparation, and then, saying oṃ āḥ hūṃ jñāna maṇḍala muḥ, request them to depart. By saying hūṃ, gather the samaya maṇḍala in. Imagine a dark blue hūṃ in front,

and imagine light radiating from it into the ten directions. By saying oṃ rakṣa rakṣa hūṃ, imagine the vajra fence and the rest.

Then the lines should be laid out. Place cotton threads of blue, white, yellow, red and green, all of them, in a vessel of gold or silver perfumed with scent, and imagine on them, in order, a blue hūṃ, a white oṃ, a yellow traṃ, a red hrīḥ and a green khaṃ. Then I, the master, sit in the center and meditate in the samādhi of Hevajra. I imagine a sun maṇḍala from mā in my right eye and a moon maṇḍala from ṭa in my left, and by reciting oṃ dīpta driṣṭi aṃ ku śa jaḥ, rays of light like hooks go out and urge the five families, Hevajra and the rest, in the sky in front. Then one should petition them thus, saying: "O Blessed One, please grant the vajra thread for laying out the lines of the maṇḍala."

Then, looking with the eye of wisdom, imagine that from the hearts of Hevajra and the others five wisdom threads come forth, as if urged on by the hooks, and dissolve one by one into the samaya threads. Then say:

All that mutually completes,
all phenomena that mutually follow,
all phenomena of perfect summoning:
remembering the first knowledge of phenomena, twist them together.

Having said this, one should twist the threads together. Then place the threads carefully, with fine sandalwood and the like, in the vessel of gold or the like. The master sits in the center and worships the line with flowers and so on. He casts the vajra gaze, positions himself in the west, and practices the yoga of Hevajra. Having recited oṃ he jāḥ as many times as he can, he emanates his assistant from his own heart in the form of Gaurī, and blesses and empowers him. Then he imagines the assistant sitting in front of him. Holding the thread in his left hand, he himself says oṃ jaḥ jaḥ jaḥ three times. Taking it with his own right hand, he should hand it into the assistant's hand. Then the assistant, stepping forward, says jaḥ three times, takes it with the vajra fist of his left hand, and sits in front of the master.

Then the sky lines are struck, so that the sound of the line may urge the sugatas to act for the welfare of sentient beings, and so that the natural maṇḍala may be made clear. For this, the master sits in the west facing east and should strike the line, saying oṃ bajra samaya sūtra mā ti kra ma hūṃ. In the same way, the master sits in the south facing north and should strike the line. Those are the sky lines.

Then take the second five-colored thread and strike the lines as before. The master and the disciple should both circle clockwise. Those are the earth lines.

Then take the wet line and strike the marking lines. Their order is as follows. The two Brahmā lines that are struck coincide with the sky lines. Then, standing in the southeast, the direction of Fire, facing north, strike the eastern line. Then, standing in the northwest, the direction of Wind, facing south, strike the western line. Staying right there, facing east, strike the northern line. Again, standing in the southeast, facing west, strike the southern line. Staying right there, facing the northwest, strike the first diagonal. Again, standing at Nairṛti in the southwest, facing Īśāna, one should strike the second diagonal. When the lines have been struck in this way:

Divide it into six parts.
In the sixth, discard the inner two.
Divide the second and the third into four each.
Leave the fourth undivided.
Discard the middle of the fifth.
From the porticoes down, work in halves.
The vajra fence and the two fire mountains
should be drawn around in accordance with the measure.

Then worship the wisdom line threads too, as before, and by saying oṃ āḥ hūṃ muḥ request them to depart. The saying "If the line thread breaks, the guru will die" should be learned from other sources. That is laying out the lines.

Then the stage of applying the colors is as follows. Use the five kinds of jewels, or flour of ground sāli rice transformed into five colors; or else, from the seed syllables of the five sources, just as the syllables were arranged on the wisdom threads, do the same for the colored powders.

Just as the wisdom threads were summoned and absorbed, so too should it be done for the colors. Then, having presented the five offerings, one should recite the mantra oṃ vajra citra samaya hūṃ seven times over the colors and gaze at the pigments with the blazing eye. The blazing eye is an eye that moves rapidly. Then recite the syllable hi. This should be done while displaying the vajra-lotus mudrā. Then, in order to make the colors excellent, one pronounces the blessing of truth, saying:

"By that truth through which the buddhas, regarding them as sentient beings, are lovingly attached to sentient beings, may the pigments blaze!"

Then, saying the following, one should lay down the colors:

"The dharmadhātu, pure in its intrinsic nature,
purifies the realm of sentient beings:
Vairocana, lord of the Victors."

Having said this, one should draw with the left fist, beginning from the quarter of Īśāna, guardian of the northeast, and moving counterclockwise. On the inside it is black; then white, then yellow, then red, then green, each drawn about a span wide. Moreover, one draws while reciting oṃ vajra citra prasara hūṃ. Then cover it with a golden basin or the like, surround its rim with flowers, and set it aside. Then, if the divination is good, one says, "How wonderful!" If it is bad, one absorbs the obstructors into the colored powder and strikes them with the ritual dagger. Then skilled disciples should draw it as is convenient. Moreover, white is in the east, yellow in the south, red in the west, green in the north, and black in the center. The passage beginning "If they are mixed, diseases will arise" should be looked up elsewhere. That is the stage of laying down the colors.

Then the emblems are to be placed. Reciting the heart mantra of each deity, one should place the emblems in order, beginning from the center. Then one performs the stances, such as the posture with the right leg extended. That is the placing of the emblems.

Generating the samaya maṇḍala is as follows. At the time of reciting the heart mantras and placing the emblems, imagine each deity arising complete all at once. Alternatively, through the five manifest awakenings, meditate on oneself as the principal deity in father and mother union. Then bless the space and the secret organ and perform the nondual union. The bodhicitta is brought down from space; it then turns into the seed syllables of the individual deities, gaṃ, caṃ and the rest; and from these it turns into the bodies of the eight goddesses. Then, reciting their individual heart mantras, gaṃ, caṃ and the rest, one should emit them from the space and place them in their respective positions. That is generating the samaya maṇḍala.

Inviting the wisdom maṇḍala and making it nondual is as follows. By saying gaurī jaḥ, Gaurī, holding the hook, summons it. By saying caurī hūṃ, Caurī, holding the noose, draws it in. By saying pramohā va, Pramohā, holding the chain, binds it. By saying betālī hoḥ, Betālī, holding the bell, brings it under control. Then one should bless the sense bases, bless them as body, speech and mind, and have them empowered by the lady of each one's family. That is

absorbing them nondually.

Then the outer, inner and secret offerings are made to them, as follows. At the eastern gate, on a peacock seat that has been spread out, take into a conch Dharma vessel the bodhicitta produced through nondual union with the action seal (karmamudrā). Mix it with camphor and saffron and imagine it as nectar. Reciting oṃ amṛta svabhāva viśuddhe, sprinkle it with the mudrā of the ring finger and thumb, and perform the purifying sprinkling for the deities of the maṇḍala. Then present the five outer offerings. Then, as the inner offering, emanate the eight goddesses, Gaurī and the rest, from the pores of one's own body hair and offer them. As the secret offering, offer the bodhicitta and the five meats. That is presenting the outer, inner and secret offerings. Then praise them with the Praise in Twenty Verses.

Then the nectar offering is made as follows. Pour nectar into the first portion of the liquor and bless it in the proper way. Reciting oṃ āḥ guru yidaṃ amṛti mahā svādāya hūṃ and sprinkling with the mudrā of the ring finger and thumb, one makes offering to the vajra master. Reciting oṃ āḥ hevajra yidaṃ amṛdaṃ svādāya hūṃ, offer it to Hevajra. Reciting oṃ āḥ gaurī idaṃ amṛtaṃ svādāya hūṃ, offer it to Gaurī. Reciting oṃ āḥ caurī yidaṃ amṛtaṃ svādāya hūṃ, offer it to Caurī. Reciting oṃ āḥ pramohā yidaṃ amṛtaṃ svādāya hūṃ, offer it to Pramohā. Reciting oṃ betālī idaṃ amṛtaṃ svādāya hūṃ, offer it to Betālī. Reciting oṃ āḥ pukkasī yidaṃ amṛtaṃ svādāya hūṃ, offer it to Pukkasī. Reciting oṃ āḥ sabarī yidaṃ amṛtaṃ svādāya hūṃ, offer it to Śabarī. Reciting oṃ āḥ caṇḍalī idaṃ amṛtaṃ svādāya hūṃ, offer it to Caṇḍālī. Reciting oṃ āḥ romi'inī idaṃ amṛtaṃ svādāya hūṃ, offer it to Ḍombī. Then offer it also to the twenty ḍākinīs. That is the nectar offering.

The feast offering is as follows. Over the feast food, recite the all-purpose action mantra, and sprinkle and purify it with scented water and nectar water. Then bless the feast as nectar in the proper way. Then unwrap the first portion, take it up with the lotus mudrā, and, reciting oṃ āḥ hevajra idaṃ paliṃ khahi, offer it into the great torma. In the same way, offer it to all the deities. Then recite the long mantra of the great torma and offer it. Then praise them with the Praise in Twenty Verses. Then take up what remains of it with the lotus mudrā and, reciting the mantra of the remainder, offer the remainder torma. The yogins, each meditating on their own chosen deity, bless the tongue as a vajra, take up the food with the jewel mudrā, and each partake of it, imagining that the deities of the aggregates, elements and sense bases are satisfied. Then, over what is left from the partaking, recite the

ucchiṣṭā mantra and imagine that the hungry ghosts who eat leftovers are satisfied. From the beginning of the rite until its conclusion, cast the torma for the guardians of the directions three times by day, and cast the torma for the ḍākinīs three times by night. That is the feast offering.

Then making offering through the fire offering is as follows. At the time of taking possession of the ground, perform the fire offering as a pacifying fire offering. At the time of the offerings, perform an enriching fire offering. At the conclusion, in order to pacify the disciples' obstructors, place the disciples on the left side and perform a pacifying fire offering. That is the fire offering.

The rite of empowerment has two parts: having the disciples enter the maṇḍala, and the means of conferring empowerment. Entering the maṇḍala has two parts: the master's entry and having the disciples enter.

The master's entry is as follows. By means of the rite for having the disciples enter, the master enters, nondual with the principal deity of the maṇḍala. Then the master should say this:

"Through great passion, from which all arises,
that wheel is like a reflection.
For the disciples' sake, together with its city,
suchness is proclaimed as bliss."

Then place the disciples outside the curtain, and, just as at the time when they stayed for the preparation, have them take the vows, put on red garments, and cover their eyes and faces. Reciting the all-purpose action mantra, perform the purifying sprinkling with water, and ask, "Joyful one, who are you?" The disciple should answer, "I am the joyful one of great fortune."

Then place the disciple at the eastern gate, and by saying oṃ sarva tathāgata hevajra pūjo basbanāya ātmanāṃ niryatayāmi te hevajra adhitiṣṭha maṃ have the disciple generate the mind set on awakening. Placing a vajra at the heart, say oṃ sarva yoga citta utpādāyami surate samya stvaṃ mahā siddha vajra yathā sukhaṃ. Then cover the eyes: tie a flower garland onto the cloth, and protect the disciple by saying namo ratna trayāya hevajras parivāra rakṣa rakṣa sarva bayebya. Then say to the disciple: "You will be blessed by all the tathāgatas. You must not speak of the secret maṇḍala of all the tathāgatas to those who have not seen it, nor indeed to those who merely have faith."

Then at the eastern gate make a maṇḍala one cubit across with a red eight-petaled lotus. In the center place a dark blue vajra; on the eastern petal

a white wheel; on the southern a yellow jewel; on the western a red lotus; on the northern a green sword; in the southeastern quarter, the quarter of fire, a jewel tree; in the southwestern quarter, the quarter of the rākṣasas, a pomegranate; in the northwestern quarter, the quarter of wind, a victory banner; and in the quarter of Īśāna a skull cup (kapāla). At the eastern gate place a vajra hook; at the southern gate a vajra noose; at the western a vajra chain; and at the northern a vajra bell. There, together with a lion throne, have the disciple take hold of the tip of the vajra. Reciting jaḥ, summon the disciple with jaḥ; by saying khaṃ vīr hūṃ, bring the disciple in and set them on the platform, and have them take up the vows. Then say: "Today you have entered the family of all the tathāgatas. Therefore I shall generate in you that vajra wisdom by which one attains even the accomplishment of all the tathāgatas, to say nothing of other accomplishments. Do not speak of it to those who have not seen the great maṇḍala, or your samaya will surely be broken."

Then, holding the vajra at the disciple's heart, say:

"Today Vajrasattva himself
abides firmly in your heart.
If you should speak of this way,
he will burst your heart, tear it open, and depart."

And say oṃ vajra satva hūṃ.

Then pour water into a conch Dharma vessel, a mother-of-pearl shell or the like. Into it pour saffron and sandalwood mixed with honey, and add the five nectars as well. Purify it with hūṃ, realize it with āḥ, and with oṃ make it increase and blaze. Then recite vajrodka mahā vajra kuraṃ viśvana seven times and give it into the right hand. Then say:

"This is your water of hell:
if the samaya is broken, it burns;
if the samaya is kept, accomplishment is gained.
Drink this vajra nectar water!"

And say oṃ vajra udaka ṭha ṭha ṭha.

Then, the samaya having been made firm, instruct the disciple as follows: "From this day on, child, I am your Vajrapāṇi. Whatever I tell you, saying, 'Do this!', you must do. Do not hold me in contempt, lest, without having given up what is dreadful, you die and fall into hell."

Then the disciple should say this, making the request: "May all the tathāgatas bless me! Please let Vajrasattva descend upon me!"

Then the master, meditating on himself as Hevajra, should meditate on the vessel for the descent, the disciple, as Amitābha. Beneath the soles of the disciple's feet, meditate on a crescent-shaped wind maṇḍala arising from yaṃ, marked with a banner. Above it, imagine a triangular fire maṇḍala arising from raṃ. Above that, imagine a red jaḥ hūṃ. Then at the heart imagine a yellow square maṇḍala of Mahendra arising from a yellow laṃ, and on it meditate on a dark blue hūṃ. At the throat meditate on a round water maṇḍala arising from a white paṃ. At the crown of the head imagine a blue crescent-shaped wind maṇḍala arising from yaṃ, and on it imagine a white ha. Then, from the light radiating from the heart, invite the deities of body, speech and mind of the ten directions and absorb them into their places.

Then, emanating outward, recite oṃ āveśa tutte saṃte vajra ghama manutaraṃ one hundred and eight times. Cast incense onto the fire, wave it around the disciple, and place it in the disciple's hand; give a flower garland into the right hand as well; and say oṃ āveśa āveśa tobaya ra ra ra ra caleha caleya hūṃ aha jhaiṃ svāhā. The wind at the soles of the feet stirs; the wind kindles the fire; the fire kindles the jāḥ hūṃ. When the light rays of the jaḥ hūṃ enter from the soles of the feet into the heart, the disciple knows what is nonvirtuous and so forth. When they enter the throat, the disciple speaks. When they enter the crown, the body becomes unsteady and leaps about. Then, by saying tiṣṭha vajra and taking hold of the one who is leaping, the disciple becomes steady. Then, imagining a red āḥ on the tongue, say, "Speak, Vajra, of virtue and nonvirtue!" and the disciple will tell of all that is good and bad.

Then take a flower from the cloth garland that covers the eyes and place it in the disciple's hand; saying pratīccha vajra hoḥ, the disciple casts it into the maṇḍala. Then the master picks it up, says, "Take this, mighty one!", and ties it onto the disciple's head.

Then say:

"O child of good family,
with your stainless and lovely eyes, how do you see?
If you see white,
rites of pacifying will be accomplished.
If you see yellow,

rites of enriching will be accomplished.
If you see red,
rites of subjugating will be accomplished.
If you see black,
fierce rites will be accomplished.
Vajrasattva himself
has today carefully opened your eyes."

Saying this, recite oṃ hevajra svayantide cakru gatana tatparana utayate sarva yagakro vajra cakrura buddharaṃ and untie the face covering.

Then one should introduce the deities, from the center of the maṇḍala up to the edge of the northern gate. Then have the disciple make offerings of flowers and the like, and have the disciple prostrate three times to the vajra master. The disciple should circumambulate the maṇḍala three times and make the aspiration, "May I attain the accomplishment of Vajrasattva!" Then the disciple should offer whatever pleases the mind: oneself, one's children, wife and so on; four-footed animals such as horses and buffaloes; precious things such as gold and silver; possessions such as fields and villages; garments of silk, mumen and the like; foods such as meat and blood; drinks such as grape wine and rice beer; and whatever else delights the master. That is the rite of having the disciple enter the maṇḍala.

The means of conferring empowerment also has two parts: outer and inner. The outer, moreover, has eleven, which are counted out in order.

Then the disciple should make the request, saying:

"Just as Vajrasattva conferred
empowerment on the Victors of the past,
so may you, endowed with good qualities, regard me with love
and grant me the awareness empowerments."

Then collect the water from the vases, the victorious vase and the rest, and pour it into a conch bowl. Visualize it as Akṣobhya alone, make offerings and praises to him, and imagine that he melts into light. Then imagine that from the light rays from the three places of Hevajra, emanations come forth pervading the whole of space. Imagine that the emanated goddesses, holding jeweled vases, confer empowerment from the crown of the head with a stream of the water of bodhicitta; and oneself also takes up the water of the conch bowl and, saying oṃ vajra kalaśa abhiṣiñca hūṃ, confers the water

empowerment. Imagine Akṣobhya on the crown of the head.

Then sprinkle a crown, of gold or the like, with water from the all-purpose action vase, and meditate on the crown as empty. From that it becomes a yellow trāṃ; from that it becomes Ratnasambhava with three faces and six arms; and imagine that from him the crown comes forth. By saying oṃ mukuṭa abhiṣiñcami, the crown empowerment is conferred, and one imagines Ratnasambhava arising behind the right ear.

Then sprinkle a vajra with the all-purpose action water and meditate on the vajra as empty. From that it becomes a red jr̄ṃ; from that it becomes Amitābha with three faces and six arms. Then, imagining that the vajra comes forth, say this:

"With the vajra, too, you are empowered:
the vajra empowerment of all the buddhas.
Being empowered today,
hold this vajra
for the accomplishment of all the buddhas."

Having said this, touch it three times to the disciple's heart and give it into the right hand. By conferring the empowerment while saying oṃ hūṃ vajra abhiṣiñcami, imagine Amitābha arising at the nape of the neck.

Then sprinkle the bell with the all-purpose action water and imagine it as empty. From that it becomes a green khaṃ; and imagine that from that it becomes Amoghasiddhi with three faces and six arms. Then say this:

"The nondual entity, wisdom and means,
whose nature is the dharmadhātu:
hold this in your left hand!
Embracing it and joining with it completely,
abide in a state like the Vajra Holder."

Having said this, reciting oṃ vajra adhipati sarya abhiṣiñcami nayaka, give the bell into the left hand and confer the empowerment, and imagine Amoghasiddhi arising behind the right ear.

Then sprinkle the vajra and bell with the all-purpose action water and imagine them as empty. From that they become a white syllable hūṃ; from that it becomes Vairocana with three faces and six arms; and imagine that from him the vajra and bell come forth. Hold them at the disciple's forehead and, by saying oṃ śrī nāma abhiṣiñcami, give the disciple the name of the deity of the

family on which the flower fell. Once the name has been given, imagine Vairocana arising at the forehead.

Then sprinkle the vajra with the all-purpose action water and imagine it as empty. From that it becomes a dark blue hūṃ; and imagine that from that it becomes a single blazing vajra. The master takes the vajra in hand and says this:

"This is the vajra of all the buddhas,
held in the hand of Vajrasattva.
You must always hold it,
firm in the discipline of Vajrapāṇi."

Having said this, the disciple takes hold of the tip of the vajra. Saying oṃ sarva tathāgata siddhi vajra samaya tiṣṭha eṣa tvaṃ dharāyami svāhā hi hi hi hi hūṃ, give the vajra into the disciple's hand and say this:

"Being without beginning or end,
Vajrasattva, great joy,
Samantabhadra, the self of all,
Vajragarbha, chief among lords."

Having said this, entrust it to the disciple's hand.

Then sprinkle the bell with the all-purpose action water and imagine it as empty. From that it becomes āḥ; and imagining that from āḥ it becomes a bell, say this:

"This is the supreme entity,
wisdom become illusion.
You must always hold it.
It was held by the Victors at their first awakening.
The wisdom of the supreme vajra
has a form like indivisible space."

Having said this, give it into the disciple's left hand. Then, holding the vajra at the heart and resting the bell at the hip, meditate vividly on oneself in the form of Vajrasattva. Then the disciple should make this supplication:

"Grant me the empowerment of the irreversible wheel!
Grant me the suchness of the maṇḍala and its deities,
and the activities of a master.
I shall always act as a master."

Then, as the master explains the suchness of the maṇḍala, the suchness of the deities and the activities of a master, the disciple understands their meaning and contemplates that he will never be turned back to saṃsāra. That is the empowerment of irreversibility.

Then give a wheel into the disciple's hand and say:

"In all the realms of the world,
to benefit sentient beings,
in whatever way they are to be trained,
in that way turn the wheel of Dharma."

In the same way, give into the hand the vajra, the jewel, the lotus and the crossed vajra, reciting the verse above. That is the empowerment of command.

Then draw the disciple who is seated in front in through one's right nostril, and imagine that the obscurations are purified by the light rays of the drop and the light rays of the wind. Then send the disciple out through the left nostril, set the disciple in front, and give the prophecy.

Meditating on oneself as Śākyamuni, one makes the left fist at the heart in the manner of holding the hem of the Dharma robe and the right hand in the gesture of giving, and says this:

"I shall prophesy concerning you:
you are the Tathāgata Vajrasattva.
To accomplish the liberation of sentient beings,
you will lead them out of the lower realms.
You are truly a tathāgata;
you are the sage of the three realms.
The buddhas, the bodhisattvas
and the noble ones, with one voice,
prophesy that you will attain
the perfect awakening of an arhat.
The supreme fruit of the Mahāmudrā
spoken of here, you will find."

That is the empowerment of prophecy.

Then one should give encouragement:

"Just as the disciples who have entered
are freed of obscurations by seeing the maṇḍala,

so today, into the family of the buddhas,
you will be born, without any doubt.
Free of all misdeeds,
having entered the secret maṇḍala,
through this vehicle of great bliss,
afterward is there death and transmigration? There is not.
Existence itself is true accomplishment;
existence and nirvāṇa are cast aside.
You are nonabiding nirvāṇa."

That is the empowerment of encouragement.

"Consecrated as vajra, hold the vajra itself
and its partner, the great bell.
Today you have become a vajra master:
devote yourself to gathering disciples."

So it comes in the Hevajra Tantra.

After that one should give the samayas:

"This vow of accomplishment and samaya
you must always guard.
The mudrā of vajra and bell
and the bodhicitta must not be given up.
Generate love toward those who do you harm.
Serve and honor your vajra brothers and sisters.
Do not disparage those who have faith.
Do not hold the master in contempt.
Do not, casting aside your own self,
practice austerities and suffering.
Holding to bliss as bliss,
you will become a perfect buddha in the future."

Thus it is proclaimed. That is the samaya of the outer empowerment.

Then set out before the disciple clothing, various foods and various drinks. Bless the clothing as divine garments, pañcalika cloth and the like, and bless the food and drink as nectar. Then, wishing the disciple auspiciousness, the guru should sing a song of auspiciousness. That is the outer empowerment.

The inner empowerment, moreover, has three: the secret empowerment, the empowerment of wisdom-gnosis, and the fourth. For this, to the north of the root maṇḍala, make a square maṇḍala for the secret empowerment, one fathom across, and make sprinklings of rakta, that is, blood, and drops of rakta. Plant four arrows at the four corners and make a curtain of cloth. On it spread white felt and white cloth, and on that scatter outer and inner flowers. Then make the request, urging thus:

"Just as offerings were made
to Bodhivajra, the Buddha,
so for my own complete liberation
grant me the vajra of space.
Bodhivajra, great hero,
grant me the secret empowerment!
Grant me the nectar of wisdom!
Grant me the arising of the vajra!"

Then take a wisdom consort who has reached sixteen years and possesses the marks, wash her with water of sandalwood, saffron, camphor and the like, adorn her with stainless silk and the like and with various jewels, and place her in the center of the maṇḍala. Bless her as Nairātmyā, and bless her eyes and the rest as Mohavajrā and the others. Bless her body, speech and mind as Khecarī and the others. Bless her five limbs as the five families. Bless the space and the secret place. Imagining her head adorned by the lord of the family, worship her with outer, inner and secret offerings, praise her with praises, and embrace her nondually. Then recite the anurāga mantra. As soon as there is stirring, sing the song of hūṃ. As soon as bliss descends, recite the pūja mantra. Then, with the elephant-trunk hand, draw the bodhicitta out of the bhaga, pour it into a conch Dharma vessel, take it up with the mudrā of the ring finger and thumb, and place it in the disciple's mouth. The disciple, saying "a ho sukha, bliss!", should drink it without conceptual thought.

"Just as the buddhas of the past
empowered the heirs of awakening,
so with my secret empowerment
I confer empowerment through the stream of mind."

So it comes in the Hevajra Tantra. That is the secret empowerment.

Then, to the south of the maṇḍala, make a square maṇḍala for the empowerment of wisdom-gnosis, one fathom across, and smear it with

sandalwood and the like and with excrement. On it spread white felt or white silk, and scatter outer and inner flowers. The blessing of the wisdom consort, the offerings and the rest are as before. Then make the request, urging thus:

"You who abide in the abode of gnosis and bliss,
be victorious, be victorious, O protector!
You whose nature is the two, the vowels and consonants,
well-pleased ocean of bliss, be victorious!
In the middle between the supreme and annihilation,
you who sport there, be victorious!
Supreme lord, grant me
the empowerment of wisdom-gnosis."

Then the master places the right hand of the wisdom consort into the left hand of the disciple and says this:

"This is your excellent consort to hold,
the buddhas declare in accord.
Through the stages of the three gnoses
she brings the experience of sublime bliss.
In the jewel vessel of the buddhas,
on the left side, is the place of the channel;
her kha khva mukha itself
is the Vajradhātvīśvarī.
By any other means, awakening
will never be found at all.
Therefore, at no time whatever
should you dwell apart from her."

Then the wisdom consort says this:

"Can you, O man,
eat this excrement and urine,
and rakta, śukra, that is, semen, and the great meat,
and likewise keep the observance of women?
Can you suck the lotus of the bhaga?
Speak, O man: how is it?"

The disciple replies:

"Goddess, what can I not do?
I can eat rakta, śukra and the rest.

I shall always keep the observance of women.
I shall suck the bhaga as well."

Then the wisdom consort says:

"The place where all bliss abides
is my lotus: how wonderful!
Whoever acts here fully,
act in accord with the purpose of the lotus!"

Then the disciple kisses the bhaga, embraces her and performs the nondual union, and, bringing down the bodhicitta, retains it by means of the oral instructions. The experience of gnosis that then arises is the empowerment of wisdom-gnosis. The Hevajra Tantra also says:

"The goddess, giver of joy, giver of a dwelling,
lovely one of manifold forms:
take her, take her, great being!
Take her and make pure offering."

That is the empowerment of wisdom-gnosis.

Then, to the west of the maṇḍala, make a maṇḍala for the fourth empowerment, one fathom across, and sprinkle it with sandalwood and the like and with bodhicitta. On it place white felt and the like, and the wisdom consort; and the blessing, the ornaments, the offerings, the praises and the rest should be done in accord with what was described above. Then the disciple makes this request:

"Homage to the inner object of touch itself!
Homage to the inner object of touch, the soft one!
Homage to the inner object of touch, the liberated one!
Homage to the inner object of touch, the giver!
This supreme empowerment of peace,
supreme lord, grant to me."

Then the guru says this:

"You must kill living beings.
You must speak falsehood.
You must take what is not given.
You must consort with the women of others.
If you do these things, there is no evil,

and great merit will arise.
If you are able to do these things,
the fourth empowerment will be given."

The disciple replies:

"By the kindness of your feet,
great protector, I am able."

Then, embracing nondually and performing the union, one brings the great bliss down into the palace of the consort, reverses it upward to the mouth of the nonconceptual one, and holds it there. The experience of nonconceptual gnosis is the fourth with support. The fourth without support is to be learned from the guru's own mouth.

"This gnosis is extremely subtle,
like the center of vajra space,
free of dust, final, peace itself;
and you yourself are its father."

So it comes in the Hevajra Tantra. Those are the means of conferring empowerment.

There is requesting the deities of the vase to depart and requesting the deities of the maṇḍala to depart. Requesting the deities of the vase to depart is done as follows: make offerings and praises to the vase, say oṃ āḥ hūṃ jñāna maṇḍala muḥ, and request them to depart. The deities of the maṇḍala are dismissed in the same way.

Dissolving the maṇḍala also has two parts: gathering in the deities of the maṇḍala and gathering up the colored powders. Gathering in the deities of the maṇḍala is as follows: light rays radiate from the heart, gather in the deities of the maṇḍala in the form of light, and absorb them into the hūṃ at the heart, making them nondual with oneself. Gathering up the colored powders is as follows: recite the akāro mantra and erase the drawing so that nothing remains. Gather it up and cast it into a great river. If there are any, such as those who guard against obstructors, who want some, it should be given to them. So that the accomplishments do not fade away, make a maṇḍala with scented water on the site of the maṇḍala and set out flowers equal in number to the deities.

The rite of empowerment composed by the great master Prajñāśrī is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The first recitation count is written □□□□□□□□□, apparently for □□□ with "boundless" (rendered "a vast number of recitations"); the following counts are clearly a hundred thousand and ten thousand. In "securing the ground," □□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□ "once the ground has been obtained," matching the later uses of □□□□; □□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□, "the earth goddess." The sentence on digging at the chest, throat, navel and knee for the three grades of accomplishment is terse, and its exact sense is uncertain. "The maṇḍala of Mahendra" is the earth maṇḍala.

• The line □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ in the verse addressed to the obstructors is obscure; it is rendered literally, and its exact sense is uncertain. □□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□, "preparing the deities," as the section heading that follows confirms. □□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "dark green hūṃ." "Samaya beings" and "wisdom deities" are the commitment and wisdom aspects of the visualized deities.

• The verse line □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken to mean "as far as I am able with the offerings." □□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□, "the six families," as later in the passage. In the lamp verse, □□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□, "virtuous, and." The "six mudrās" are the six bone ornaments.

• □□□□□□, taken up with the vajra fist to mark the disciple's crown, throat and heart, is rendered "urine" according to its tantric sense, as the house glossary directs; some traditions may understand scented water here. The rinsing phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is terse and is rendered according to its evident sense.

• The four-line verse spoken over the threads before they are twisted is obscure and is rendered literally. In the measuring verse, the lines rendered "In the sixth, discard the inner two" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) and "From the porticoes down, work in halves" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) are uncertain. The Tibetan □□□□□□□□ in the verse to the disciples is taken as "take this!", referring to the protective thread. In "strike the lines as before," the Tibetan □□□ is read as □□. The master sometimes speaks in the first person in this passage ("I, the master"), as the Tibetan does.

• The verse of the blessing of truth is terse; "regarding them as sentient beings" renders a phrase whose exact sense is uncertain. In "the bodhicitta is brought down from space" and in the secret offering, the Tibetan reads "bodhisattva", which here plainly stands for bodhicitta, the generative essence of the union, and is translated so. In the inner offering, "snake" in the Tibetan is read as the similar-looking "emanate", which the context requires. The drawing "a span wide" reflects the Tibetan "about one span".

• The clause "nor indeed to those who merely have faith" renders a terse Tibetan phrase whose exact force is uncertain. "The vessel for the descent" is the disciple onto whom the deity is made to descend; the text says it is visualized as Amitābha. "Without having given up what is dreadful" renders an obscure phrase; the sense is a warning of the consequences of breaking the master's command.

• "Mumen" is kept as a name: as an item of clothing it is unclear, since the word elsewhere names a precious stone. The text places Amoghasiddhi, like Ratnasambhava, "behind the right ear"; this is translated as it stands, though one of the two may originally have read "left". "Forehead" renders a rare word for the front of the head, where Vairocana is placed. The disciple is drawn in through the master's nostril in visualization.

• "The perfect awakening of an arhat" follows the Tibetan, where "arhat" is used as an epithet of a fully awakened buddha. The phrase rendered "the vajra itself and its partner, the great bell" is terse in the Tibetan. "The three gnoses" refers to the stages of the joys experienced in the wisdom-gnosis empowerment. The "great meat" is human flesh, one of the substances of the tantric observance.

• The guru's injunctions to kill, lie, steal and consort with others' women are quoted from the Hevajra tradition, where the commentaries read them as coded instructions (for example, "killing" as stopping the life-wind or conceptual thought), not as literal license. "The nonconceptual one" most likely names the central channel. The second line of the Hevajra verse ("giver of joy, giver of a dwelling") is translated literally; its exact sense is uncertain.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.